

Ngā Tikanga Paihere for Cuisine Compass



Data Governance & Māori Principles

The *Multicultural Cuisine Compass* project embraces **Māori data sovereignty** and ethical data governance by aligning with the following principles:



Principle 1: Pūkenga & Whakapapa

(Expertise & Relationships)

"Emphasizes having appropriate expertise, skills, and relationships with communities."

- The project team includes culturally aware developers and AI practitioners.
 - LLM-generated content about food origins is created with cultural sensitivity.
 - Restaurant and cultural data is sourced responsibly with acknowledgment of its origins (e.g., Yelp, food communities).
 - Opportunities exist to partner with local iwi or cultural associations to ensure cultural accuracy and representation in stories.
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Principle 2: Pono & Tika

(Integrity & Trust)

"Focuses on maintaining public confidence and trust in data use."

- User data (email, reviews, profile) is securely stored and access-controlled using JWT and role-based policies.
 - Reviews and interactions are transparently moderated using AI for toxicity and bias.
 - Clear consent and transparency are maintained for data collection (e.g., registration and API use).
 - No user data is sold or shared externally without consent.
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Principle 3: Wānanga & Kaitiaki

(Deliberation & Guardianship)

"Highlights the importance of using good data standards and practices."

- Follows strong database practices (PostgreSQL, SQLAlchemy schema validation).
 - All endpoints are rigorously typed and documented with OpenAPI/Swagger.
 - Background jobs (e.g., food stories) use scheduled, traceable AI generations with logs.
 - API rate limiting and exception handling protect the integrity of the system.
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Principle 4: Wairua & Mauri

(Purpose & Vitality)

"Ensures clear purpose and action in data activities."

- Every feature (recommendation, cultural story, review) serves a clear purpose: enhancing multicultural understanding through food.
 - AI-generated content focuses on celebration, education, and cultural respect.
 - The platform does not collect unnecessary data; only data that supports community value and user experience is captured.
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Principle 5: Tapu & Noa

(Sacredness & Balance)

"Aims to balance benefits and risks in data use."

- Risks of misrepresentation in cultural stories are mitigated by AI moderation and planned human curation.
 - User-generated content (e.g., reviews) is monitored to prevent harm or cultural insensitivity.
 - Feedback mechanisms allow users to flag content, reinforcing mutual responsibility.
 - AI recommendations avoid stereotyping by grounding in diverse, real user data.
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Continuous Review

Data practices will be regularly reviewed to maintain alignment with both Māori values and technical standards. Feedback from cultural partners and users will guide improvements.